

IS THERE A HEAVEN?

Good heavens! What is this mysterious afterworld that people talk of? The concept of heaven changes depending on religious beliefs, but it is generally described as a place where people live a joyful and peaceful eternal life, without any of the negative stuff they left behind on Earth. Who wouldn't be knocking on heaven's door? But not everyone is allowed entry, and you have to be good to get on this guest list. Oh, you are? In that case, step inside the ultimate residence and slip into something more heavenly.

GET YOUR GLAD RAGS ON



A NEW OUTFIT

Followers of the Buddhist faith believe that there is more than one heaven. If you have done good things in life, you will go to a heaven after you die, but your stay there is temporary. Heaven is similar to a changing room where you enter as yourself, then emerge in a new form. Buddhists believe that the spirits of the dead are eventually reincarnated into another person or animal to live again.



TO DIE FOR

People are dying to get into heaven. The rules for getting there differ between religions, but being dead is almost always a requirement. Some religions teach that you enter heaven the moment you die; others have a waiting period. If you have not lived a good life, it will be difficult to get in, but Protestant Christians can ask Jesus to forgive their sins and be admitted to heaven. Many people scoff at ideas about heaven and think death is the final curtain.



SUITS EWE!

The Christian notion of heaven is described in the Bible as a peaceful kingdom where people live alongside flocks of sheep in the beautiful sunlight. Heaven is also sometimes likened to a glorious garden of paradise or a shining celestial city. It doesn't sound baaaad, so people are positively flocking to enter this heavenly kingdom. Wool they get in is another question completely.